

Monte Logistics Ltd – Backup Procedures

Overview

This document outlines the essential data backup procedures for Monte Logistics Ltd to ensure business continuity, data integrity, and rapid recovery in the event of data loss, system failure, or disaster. Adherence to these procedures is mandatory for all relevant personnel.

Scope

These procedures apply to all critical company data, including:

- Client databases
- Logistics and tracking information
- Financial records
- Employee data
- Operational documentation
- System configurations

Backup Strategy

Monte Logistics Ltd employs a multi-tiered backup strategy, combining on-site and off-site solutions to provide robust data protection.

1. Daily Incremental Backups (On-site & Cloud)

- **Data Covered:** All critical operational databases (e.g., ERP, WMS, TMS), shared network drives.
- **Frequency:** Daily, outside of core business hours (e.g., 2:00 AM GMT).
- **Method:** Incremental backups, capturing changes since the last full or incremental backup.
- **Storage:**
 - **Primary:** On-site Network Attached Storage (NAS) array.
 - **Secondary:** Secure cloud storage (e.g., Azure Blob Storage, AWS S3) via encrypted transfer.
- **Retention:** 30 days of daily incremental backups.

2. Weekly Full Backups (On-site & Off-site)

- **Data Covered:** Full images of critical servers, complete database dumps, and all active shared drives.
- **Frequency:** Weekly, typically over the weekend (e.g., Sunday 1:00 AM GMT).
- **Method:** Full system and data backups.
- **Storage:**
 - **Primary:** Dedicated on-site backup server/appliance.
 - **Secondary (Off-site):** Encrypted external drives rotated weekly and stored at a secure, geographically separate location.
- **Retention:** 4 weekly full backups, with one monthly backup archived for 1 year.

3. Key Workstation Data Backups

- **Data Covered:** Critical files stored on individual employee workstations (e.g., documents, spreadsheets not stored on shared drives).
- **Frequency:** Automated hourly syncing to designated network folders or cloud storage for approved data.
- **Responsibility:** Employees are responsible for ensuring critical work-related files are stored in network shares or approved cloud services that are included in automated backups. Local-only storage is discouraged for vital data.

Backup Verification

- **Regular Testing:** Quarterly, random backup sets will be selected and tested for restorability. This includes performing test restores to isolated environments to verify data integrity and recovery procedures.
- **Logs Review:** Backup job logs are reviewed daily by the IT team to confirm successful completion and identify any failures or warnings.

Data Recovery Procedures

In the event of data loss or system failure:

1. **Assess Impact:** Determine the extent of data loss and affected systems.
2. **Isolate Issue:** Prevent further data corruption.
3. **Identify Recovery Point Objective (RPO):** Determine the last viable backup point.
4. **Identify Recovery Time Objective (RTO):** Estimate the time needed to restore services.
5. **Restore Data:** Utilise the most recent verified backup from the appropriate storage (on-site or cloud/off-site).
6. **Verify Restoration:** Confirm data integrity and system functionality post-restore.

7. **Post-Incident Review:** Document the incident, recovery process, and implement preventative measures.

Employee Responsibilities

- Save all critical work to designated network drives or approved cloud storage.
- Report any suspected data loss or system issues immediately to the IT Department.
- Adhere to all data handling and security policies.

Contact

For any questions regarding backup procedures or in the event of a data loss incident, please contact the IT Department immediately.